

3. MODERN HISTORY OF INDIA

The Advent of European Companies

1. Who was the first Portuguese Viceroy in India?

- (a) Diaz (b) Vasco da Gama
(c) Almeida (d) Albuquerque

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Vasco da Gama arrived on western-coast port of Calicut in 1498 A.D. He discovered a new and all sea route to India and he was welcomed by Zamorin, the then king of Calicut. The voyage of Vasco da Gama opened the new trade dimensions of the Indo-Portuguese alliance. Vasco da Gama earned 60 times more profit in Europe by black pepper trade from India, which encouraged other Portuguese traders. The Portuguese merchants established their commercial firms in India at the ports of Calicut, Goa, Daman, Diu and Hooghly. Vasco da Gama revisited India in 1502. Francisco de Almeida came to India in 1505 as the first Portuguese Viceroy and Albuquerque came to India in 1509 after him as a new Viceroy. He annexed Goa in 1510 from Bijapur ruler Adil Shah. The Portuguese maintained Goa as the epicentre of their culture and entity.

2. Who used Hooghly as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal?

- (a) The Dutch (b) The French
(c) The Portuguese (d) The British
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The Portuguese used Hooghly as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal. In 1632, Qasim Khan who was the Governor of Bengal during Shahjahan's reign finally subdued and imprisoned thousands of Portuguese.

3. Dutch East India Company established its factory at Patna in which year?

- (a) 1601 (b) 1632
(c) 1774 (d) 1651
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (b)

Dutch East India Company established its factory at Patna in 1632 A.D., while it was closed in the same year. Although historian Om Prakash has given proofs for establishment of a Dutch factory in Patna in 1638 A.D. which was closed down the same year due to money problem.

4. Where in India did Britishers set up their first factory in 1613?

- (a) Goa (b) Hooghly in Bengal
(c) Amarkot (d) Surat

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Ans. (d)

Captain William Hawkins reached Mughal Court from Surat in 1609 but did not succeed in getting permission to set up a factory. Despite Portuguese antagonism, Captain Middleton landed at Sowley near Surat and succeeded in getting permission for trade with Mughal Governor in 1611. Captain Thomas Best dissolved the Portuguese monopoly with the victory of Surat port. Consequently, the British established a permanent factory in 1613 A.D. They expanded their trade to other parts of India and established cooperative factories in Ahmedabad, Burhanpur, Ajmer and Agra immediately.

5. Which of the British officials defeated Portuguese at Sowley?

- (a) William Hawkins (b) Thomas Best
(c) Thomas Roe (d) Josiah Child

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Ans. (b)

After defeating Portuguese at Sowley near Surat in 1612, English established their factor at Surat. Captain Thomas Best was responsible for this English win.

6. Which one of the following was the immediate cause of the First Carnatic War?

- (a) Anglo-French Rivalry
(b) Austrian War of Succession
(c) Issues of Carnatic Succession
(d) Capture of French ships by the British

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Ans. (d)

The First Carnatic War (1746-48 A.D.) was an offshoot of the Anglo-French rivalry in the Austrian War of Succession that took place in Europe in 1740 A.D. The British Captain Bernett captured some French ships which became the immediate cause of war. Nawab Anwaruddin sent an army under the command of Mahfooz Khan to besiege the French in Madras during the First Carnatic War. The French Army (under command of Captain Paradise) defeated Nawab's Army at the Battle of St. Thome near Adyar river. Treaty of Aix-Le-Chapelle (18 Oct, 1748) ended the War of Austrian succession and with it first Carnatic War ended and the Britishers reoccupied Madras. The first Carnatic War is memorable for War of St. Thome.